

SELF-REGULATION STRATEGIES

You may have things you already do to help calm yourself or perhaps have been working with your clinician to develop strategies to help you get back into your “zone” where you feel relaxed and present. In this booklet, you’ll learn some ways you can calm your body and mind if you become overwhelmed or distressed.

Please note, these strategies are not meant to replace mental health care from a professional.

Audio and visual guides for some strategies are available through the [Prepped 4 Learning Video Membership](#).

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Double Breathing

Take a deep breath in through your nose, then breathe in through your nose some more (This may feel similar to a yawn).

Breathe out.

Do this four or five times and notice how you feel.



Recenter with Your Senses

Notice your body as it is supported by the chair you are sitting in or the ground beneath your feet. If it is appropriate and temperatures permit, go outside, take off your shoes and feel the sensation of your bare feet in the grass.

When we are stressed, our mouths can dry up. Help your body recognize it is safe enough by drinking some water or tea or sucking on a hard candy. If you do not have any water, tea, or hard candies nearby you can imagine sucking on a piece of lemon – your mouth can begin to produce saliva by imagining the sour taste.

While you drink your water or tea or suck on the hard candy notice how they taste, smell and feel.

Listen to music you enjoy, talk to a friend, or go outside and listen to the sounds around you to engage your sense of hearing.

Have something with a pleasant scent nearby – like fresh orange, or an essential oil or candle you enjoy. Some grounding scents include frankincense and rosemary.



Therapeutic Techniques

You may have been working with your mental health clinician to develop some strategies to help calm your body and mind. Here, we will describe some of these strategies:

The Container

When we have something that is upsetting us and needs to be set aside for now, we can use our container until we have time to review it. Our brain knows what needs to be set aside and is able to do this automatically. You may have selected a container with your clinician, or you may want to follow the Prepped 4 Learning container video to choose one and learn to use it.

Practice using your container throughout the day. Remember, practice makes permanent!

Container adapted from R.P. Kulft (1988)

